Day 1: Osmosis Practice Questions

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Q1 Define osmosis based on water potential.

Q2 What was the percentage change in mass of potato strips in 0.4 M sucrose, and what conclusion was drawn from this?

Q3 Explain why potato strips placed in 0.8 M sucrose lost mass and became limp.

Answers

Osmosis is the net movement of water across a partially permeable membrane, from high water potential to low water potential.

The change in mass was 0 percent (no net change). This indicates that potato cells are isotonic with about 0.4 M sucrose.

In 0.8 M sucrose, the external solution is hypertonic to the cells, causing water to leave the potato cells by osmosis, resulting in plasmolysis and loss of turgor.